

Roll for the Galaxy: Roll & Sow Prototype

Status: experimental mechanism test for 1-4 players. This does not replace the main Phase Battery rules unless a later playtest adopts it.

What This Prototype Tests

Roll & Sow keeps Roll's dice, tiles, Credits, Goods, construction, and phase powers. It changes what happens after dice are rolled:

1. rolled dice remain in five phase bowls;
2. players secretly select a nonempty bowl;
3. every selected phase activates that bowl for every player;
4. useful dice are spent as workers;
5. every unused die is sown clockwise into later bowls.

The intended tension is that another player can activate your bowl before you want it activated. You may benefit from their phase, but your unused dice will move and change your future choices.

Components

Use the base Roll for the Galaxy components, plus one printed Roll & Sow board per player. Each board has five bowls in this order:

Explore -> Develop -> Settle -> Produce -> Ship -> Explore

Use the normal player screens and phase tiles. A player needs a way to select a phase secretly without moving a die out of its bowl; place the matching phase tile or a phase marker behind the screen.

Remove all six-cost Developments from the normal tile supply. They are delayed end-game goals, not construction tiles. Keep their physical tiles near the shared goal reference.

Setup

1. Shuffle the 10 six-cost Developments and reveal $2 + \text{player count}$ as the shared goal pool. Each player records or marks 2 candidate goals. Candidates are not exclusive: multiple players may choose the same revealed goal.
2. Use the normal starting Faction and Home World procedure. Choose starting tiles after goal candidates so players can draft toward a goal. Apply printed die gains using **Gaining Dice** below.
3. Give each player 5 White Home dice. Roll 3 and place each in the bowl shown by its face. Put the other 2 in Citizenry.
4. Give each player 1 Credit. Credits are unlimited chips; the dial cap is not used.
5. Give each player one Development and one World under construction. A player may later hold up to 3 Developments and 3 Worlds under construction.
6. Make a VP-chip pool of 7 chips per player.
7. Randomize the ordinary tiles. Keep a face-down discard pile beside the bag. Keep unrevealed six-cost goals separate from this bag.

Starting-tile dice are in addition to the 5 White dice. A printed Cup gain is rolled immediately. A Citizenry gain begins in Citizenry. A World gain begins as a Good on that World.

Round Sequence

Each round has five steps.

1. Select

Each player secretly selects one nonempty bowl. Reassign powers may move dice only after choosing that bowl and before selections are revealed. A Reassign power does not change a die's color.

A player with no dice in any bowl selects nothing this round.

2. Reveal

Reveal simultaneously. Every phase selected by at least one player will occur.

In a two-player game, also roll one White die from the supply. Its face adds that phase this round, following the normal two-player Roll rule.

3. Resolve Selected Phases

Resolve selected phases in normal order:

Explore -> Develop -> Settle -> Produce -> Ship

When a phase begins, every player activates its matching bowl, even if another player selected the phase. Pick up all dice currently in that bowl. Dice sown into a later selected bowl can therefore activate later in the same round.

Choose how many dice to spend as described under **Phase Actions**, including zero. After the action, sow all unused dice from the activated bowl. Printed phase powers resolve normally when their phase occurs, even if their owner had no die in that bowl.

4. Manage Empire

Recruit dice from Citizenry for 1 Credit each. As in Roll, recruit as many as you can afford. Roll every recruited die immediately and put it in the bowl shown by its face. Assign a Wild face to any bowl.

If a player has 0 Credits after recruiting, set their Credits to 1.

After recruiting, you may Recall dice from construction progress or Goods and roll them immediately into their face bowls. At minimum, if all five bowls are empty, you must Recall one such die if possible. Remove recalled construction progress or the recalled Good normally. This prevents a player from becoming locked out with every die committed off-board.

5. Check End Of Game

After Manage Empire, check the six-cost commitment trigger. Finish the round if the VP pool is empty or any player has at least 12 tableau squares. Score normal Roll VP plus committed six-cost goals.

Activating And Sowing

Dice are removed from a bowl before its action. Their destinations depend on whether they are used.

Die use	Destination
Explore	Citizenry after Scouting or Stocking
Develop	stays as progress; all progress dice go to Citizenry when the Development completes
Settle	stays as progress; all progress dice go to Citizenry when the World completes
Produce	becomes the Good on the chosen production World
Ship	the Shipper and shipped Good both go to Citizenry
Unused	sown clockwise into phase bowls

To sow, place the first unused die in the next bowl clockwise, the second in the following bowl, and so on. Continue around the loop as often as necessary. The player chooses the order of different-colored dice being sown. Bowls have no capacity limit.

Example: Develop is selected. Mira activates 3 dice in Develop but needs only 1 to complete a Development. That die goes to Citizenry with any older progress dice. She sows the other 2 dice: one into Settle and one into Produce. If Settle or Produce is also selected this round, the newly sown die will activate there.

Phase Actions

Explore

Choose Scout or Stock.

Scout: spend 1 or more Explorers together. The first die inspects 4 tiles; each additional die inspects 1 more tile. Draw that many physical tiles and inspect both sides. Keep 1 tile on either side and add it to the matching construction row. Put rejected tiles in the face-down discard pile. When the bag cannot supply the full draw, shuffle the discard pile into a new bag.

$$\text{tiles inspected} = 3 + \text{dice spent}$$

Scout may be performed only once per Explore activation. You may spend fewer dice than are present and sow the rest.

Stock: instead spend exactly 1 Explorer to gain 2 Credits. Sow all other Explorers. Alien Archeology changes an Alien Stock to 4 Credits as printed.

Claim Goal: instead spend exactly 1 Explorer to take one unrevealed six-cost Development from outside the shared setup pool. Before the commitment trigger it becomes another candidate. After commitment it becomes an additional committed goal and will score or suffer the penalty independently. Sow every other Explorer.

An extra virtual Explorer from a tile power adds 1 candidate without requiring or moving a physical die. Alien Research Ship adds 2 candidates. Alien Research Team may keep the printed extra tile, subject to the construction-row limit.

Develop

Spend Developers one at a time as permanent progress on any Development under construction. A die pays 1 point of cost. You may split dice among several Developments and may complete several in one phase.

When a Development is complete, move it to the tableau, resolve its immediate effects, and move all dice on it to Citizenry. Cost reductions reduce the number of dice required and never reduce a Development below cost 1.

Settle

Settle works like Develop. Spend Settlers one at a time as permanent progress on any World under construction. Red is not a separate military system in this prototype: every World costs settlers equal to its printed cost. Multiple Worlds may complete in one phase.

When a World is complete, move it to the tableau, resolve its immediate effects, and move all dice on it to Citizenry. Printed World cost reductions apply and never reduce a World below their printed minimum.

Produce

Spend any number of Producers one at a time. Each places itself as a Good on a chosen empty, non-gray production World. A World normally holds at most one Good. Sow every unused die.

Ship

Spend any number of Shippers one at a time. Each ships one Good. Choose either:

- **Trade:** gain Credits from the World color: Novelty 3, Rare Elements 4, Genes 5, Alien Technology 6.
- **Consume:** gain 1 VP chip from the shared pool.

After shipping, move both the Shipper and Good dice to Citizenry. There is no Shipper-color or Good-color matching bonus in the basic action. Resolve printed Trade and Consume powers normally.

Gaining And Losing Dice

Printed die location is preserved.

- **Cup:** gain the die, roll it immediately, and place it in its face-matching bowl. A Wild may enter any bowl.
- **Citizenry:** gain the die in Citizenry. It costs 1 Credit to recruit later.
- **World:** gain the die as a Good on that World. It does not roll first.

To lose a die, remove an owned die using the printed restriction. Prefer Citizenry, then bowls, Goods, and construction progress unless the power says otherwise.

Printed Powers

Use the spreadsheet/base-game text wherever its concept still exists.

- Reassign powers temporarily move a legal source die to their printed destination during Select. They do not alter die color.
- A routed Producer or Shipper performs the ordinary destination action; source color does not change the Good, Trade value, or Consume value.
- Extra phase workers are virtual workers for that phase. They do not become owned dice and are not sown.
- Development and World cost reductions reduce required progress dice.
- Cup/Citizenry/World die placement follows **Gaining And Losing Dice**.
- Phase-end Credit and VP powers trigger whenever that phase occurs.

Advanced Logistics and Improved Reconnaissance have no additional effect because construction is already parallel and a Scout may already choose either side. Backup Planning should be read as one unrestricted Reassign for this prototype because Dictate is not separately modeled.

Six-Cost End-Game Goals

Goal cards remain outside the tableau and construction rows. They do not grant their printed ongoing phase powers, do not add their printed 6 VP, and do not count toward the 12-square end condition. Only their converted minimum and printed end-game bonus apply.

Commitment

Commit goals after Manage Empire when either condition first occurs:

- half of the starting VP chips are gone; or
- any player has completed 6 Developments/Worlds.

Each player commits 1 of their candidates. Unchosen shared candidates remain in the central pool because another player may have marked them. If the game ends before either trigger, commit immediately before final scoring.

Each goal claimed through Explore after this trigger is immediately committed. A player may have several committed goals; score each independently.

Minimums And Bonuses

A fulfilled goal scores its converted version of the spreadsheet's printed end-game bonus. An unfulfilled goal scores **-6 VP** instead. The goal itself is included where its original formula would normally count the built six-cost Development.

Goal	Minimum to avoid -6 VP	Fulfilled bonus
Free Trade Association	2+ Novelty Worlds	Half total Novelty World cost, rounded up
Galactic Bankers	Ship 4+ Goods	1 VP per Development, including this goal
Galactic Exchange	1+ Alien Technology World	1 VP per different die color owned
Galactic Federation	4+ Developments	One third total Development cost including this goal, rounded up
Galactic Renaissance	8+ completed tiles	1/2/3/4... VP for 1/3/6/10... VP chips
Galactic Reserves	10+ owned dice	1 VP per Good remaining
Mining League	2+ Rare Elements Worlds	2 VP per Rare Elements World
New Economy	3+ production Worlds	1 VP per non-Reassign Development, including this goal
New Galactic Order	5+ Military dice	2 VP per 3 Military dice owned, rounded up
System Diversification	4+ World colors	Half total Reassign-Development cost including this goal, rounded up

The 10-die Industrial minimum is the Roll & Sow conversion of Phase Battery's max-pip requirement. It is a playtest value, not printed Roll text.

Provisional Solo Test

Solo is included only as a loop test; its difficulty has not been tuned.

1. Set up one player, a 24-chip VP pool, and the normal 3-card shared goal pool.
2. Shuffle one card for each of the five phases.
3. Each round, select one nonempty bowl and reveal one phase card. Both phases occur; if they match, the phase occurs once.
4. Discard the phase card. Reshuffle all five after the deck is exhausted.
5. End after 20 rounds, 12 tableau squares, or an empty VP pool.

Record final VP, completed tiles, dice owned, and unused dice sown. Do not use existing campaign thresholds for this untuned mode.

First Playtest Questions

After playing, answer these before changing numbers:

1. Did an opponent ever activate a bowl earlier than you wanted?
2. Did sowing create a plan for a later phase, or was it only handling?
3. Were Credits scarce enough to make Citizenry recruitment painful?
4. Did seeing 4+ tiles make Explore satisfying without making tile choice easy?
5. Did construction dice feel trapped compared with Produce and Ship dice?
6. How many distinct phases occurred per round?
7. Did the goal candidates guide tile choices, or merely add end scoring?
8. Was any committed goal an automatic success or unavoidable -6 VP?